

800 GB SSD

SanDisk has introduced a mammoth 800 GB SSD aimed at the enterprise sector

Adobe Flash Catalyst

This is Adobe's tool that lets you create user interfaces for rich internet applications

SSDs: The future of drives

9.9 Media's IT Next magazine, in association with Kingston Technology Corp., a leading maker of solid-state drives, or SSDs, drew an enthusiastic response from senior IT managers and CIOs alike, reflecting the growing popularity of SSDs among enterprise users

The hard drive has come a long way from its original two-part avatar where one spun the disc and the other took care of the read-write mechanism. It's come so far from that mid-previous-century model, in fact, that today there are drives that don't spin at all.

From a growth perspective, market researcher IDC, which last year forecast "tangible" levels of growth within the solid state drive (SSD) market until at least 2013, expects SSD shipments will achieve a compound growth rate of 54 per cent over the 2008 to 2013 forecast period.

HDD: Bottleneck

Two of Kingston's engineers visited India and spoke to IT managers and CIOs, at the IT Next

roundtables, and sought to spread word about the latest exciting possibilities with SSDs.

The tremendous improvement in the performance of processor chips, from the early Pentium series to the most recent Intel i7 series, has left the hard disc way behind, said Sammy Hsu, a Kingston Technical Resources Group engineer, based in Taiwan.

"The hard disc is the bottleneck," Hsu said, at the event, in explaining the advantage of the SSD, which could provide much higher access speeds in comparison with the conventional hard drive. "To get the 4,000 IOPS we would need 95,000 rpm," on the hard drive, "which is ridiculous," he said. "If you want to achieve such speeds, only SSD is the option," he added.



The SSD, available at capacities ranging from 64 GB to 512 GB, also offered considerably more resilience to such things as laptops falling and sustaining damage in the increasingly mobile world of most corporate users, Hsu said.

SSD: The solution

The SSD elegantly replaces the conventional hard drive's magnetic components with non-magnetic, optical and electrical components. Further, it does away with the moving parts of the hard drive and instead offers a combination of a 'flash' memory device and a 'controller.' The SSD offers considerably faster access times in comparison with the hard drive, Hsu said.

These solid-state drives, with no

moving parts also offer better resilience against vibrations and temperature changes, he said. Kingston's NAND-based SSDs are available in both 2.5 inch and 1.8 inch form factors, and include products such as the 100E series that come with built-in security encryptions.

Upgrading to SSDs could mean a significant increase in the efficiency of an enterprise user's laptop, for instance, Hsu said. This could come in terms of the time taken for the notebook to boot, or launch an application and so on. Modern SSDs also come with programs that allocate new data writing to the particular chip within the drive that has been least used, for instance, and help ensure that the SSD doesn't wear out easily.

They can also be equipped with programs, on the control, that will clean up unwanted files during idle time, or in the background so that the next time a user needs space or needs to access important files that are heavy, chances are, an SSD equipped notebook will make him wait a lot less than the conventional drive. **d**

Adobe's offering for a richer experience

Adobe recently organised a briefing session for the developer community to share more information on their latest product offering – Flash Builder 4.5. Adobe has released several major updates since launching this useful software suite about 12 months ago.

Adobe team members Srihari Palangala and Vyshak Venugopalan demonstrated how you could create and deploy an

app across popular platforms such as Apple iOS and Google's Android to even BlackBerry's Playbook – all in under 5 minutes! The demonstrated was live on actual devices that included the iPhone, iPad and Samsung's Galaxy Tab.

With the latest update, Adobe has now supports development, testing as well as deploying AIR applications across the above mobile and tablet platforms.

What's new in Flash Builder 4.5

This latest update from Adobe gives you a templatised environment so that you don't have to worry about code details, and MXML, ActionScript and CSS is inserted as pre-defined blocks straight into your code. In fact, there are over 100 templates that you can choose from. With Quick Assist, you have access to code-related operations. To get help with code, all you need to do is press Ctrl + 1.

Also, with Flash Catalyst CS5, interaction designers can view projects and collaborate with designers working on other products such as Photoshop and Illustrator, while still monitoring

Flex projects. In addition to this, Catalyst provides improved code generation, supports resizing of the UI, and ensures isolation between user interface controls and design modifications.

Finally, Flash Builder 4.5 also has a version aimed specifically at PHP developers. The integration of Flash Builder 4.5 and Zend Studio 8 lets you streamline your development process so that you can build web and mobile applications using Flex and PHP. The suite also includes an integrated installer, new project wizards, improved connection to PHP services, and joint debugging workflows.